

Work that nourishes mind, body and soul

Why do you work? The obvious answer is: To **sustain** myself and my family, of course! Some may say they love their profession or occupation, it is their **passion**, and so on, but they will rarely do it **gratis**. **Monetary** returns is a given in one's work-life, especially if you have no other source of income.

What if the work that you do, day in and day out, **throughout** your productive years – starting from the first **bloom** of adult youth right up to the **verge** of your senior years towards retirement – had been **feeding** only your body and maybe some bit of your mind but leaves your soul quite **famished** and **emaciated**?

Letting work get the better of you to the extent of neglecting your soul, can be pretty tragic. It may even kill you, not just **metaphorically**, but physically, too. You are probably saying, 'My work crushes my soul but I have no other alternative.'

There is a way to have your cake and eat it too. At least, a little, now and then. Find a creative **outlet**; something you can do with your hands. Something that relaxes you, makes you feel joy, and which does not stress you with deadlines and projections, expectations and targets. Something that lets you be. It could be playing a musical instrument like the piano or veena; it could be **origami**, doll-making, **embroidery**, carpentry, gardening, sewing, or basket weaving, painting, sculpture – anything that feeds your soul.

Once you begin to do this, you will find that your 'real' work gets transformed, too. At the office you find yourself being more **efficient**, **germinating** ideas, looking at problems with new eyes, with better time management and interpersonal skills – the possibilities are **vast** and exciting. You are now transforming your working hours and your personal time; you are no longer **vegging-out** in front of the television or scrolling aimlessly, watching reels and jokes that don't really register. You save valuable time and energy.

You are able to **converse** and interact in **constructive** ways. You find time to look around you, and notice things you never 'saw' before. Your mind, body and soul are now partying together, giving you highs you never before thought were possible. You are a bundle of **syncretic** and positive energy, and you begin to **radiate** the joy you experience within, to all around you.

You have all the conditions that **propel** you on the spiritual path. You are becoming more compassionate, less **narcissistic**, more loving and caring and appreciative of all the good things around you. You complain less. You are **overcoming** the **monotony** of work, work, work that was **starving** your soul. You now see even **rote** work as an opportunity to **improvise** and reimagine the way you do things. You begin to nourish your soul and **reclaim** your true nature.

An **offshoot** of the fast food explosion **was** the slow-food movement that **exalted** traditional, artisanal food consumed unhurriedly. Audio-visual dominance saw the return of book clubs and considered

reading. Nine-to-five workers can **turn their sights on** creative **pursuit**, letting it **permeate** their work ethic as well. The highest **reward** for a man's **toil** **is** not what he gets for it but what he becomes by it, wrote John Ruskin.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

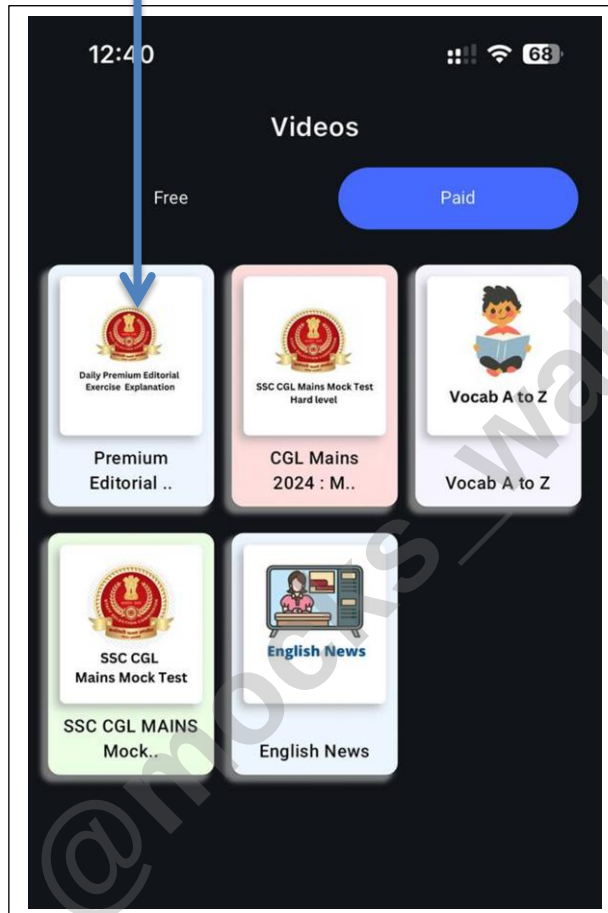
@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Nourish** (verb) – feed, nurture, sustain, develop, strengthen पोषण करना
2. **Sustain** (verb) – maintain, support, uphold, continue, preserve बनाए रखना / जीवित रखना
3. **Passion** (noun) – enthusiasm, fervor, zeal, ardor, love जुनून
4. **Gratis** (adverb/adjective) – free, without charge, complimentary, costless, unpaid मुफ्त
5. **Monetary** (adjective) – financial, fiscal, economic, pecuniary, commercial मौद्रिक / आर्थिक
6. **Throughout** (adverb) – during, across, all over, from beginning to end, all through पूरे समय
7. **Bloom** (noun) – blossom, flowering, prime, flourishing, efflorescence खिलना
8. **Verge** (noun) – edge, brink, threshold, cusp, margin कगार
9. **Feed** (verb) – nourish, supply, provide, sustain, energize पोषण करना
10. **Famished** (adjective) – starving, hungry, ravenous, malnourished, empty भूखा
11. **Emaciated** (adjective) – thin, wasted, gaunt, skeletal, undernourished कुपोषित / कमजोर
12. **Metaphorically** (adverb) – symbolically, figuratively, allegorically, poetically, representatively रूपक रूप में
13. **Outlet** (noun) – expression, escape, release, channel, vent अभिव्यक्ति का माध्यम
14. **Origami** (noun) – paper folding, paper art, Japanese folding art, folding design, craft कागज़ मोड़ने की कला
15. **Embroidery** (noun) – needlework, stitching, ornamentation, decoration, embellishment कढ़ाई
16. **Efficient** (adjective) – effective, productive, competent, capable, organized कुशल
17. **Germinate** (verb) – sprout, develop, emerge, generate, produce उत्पन्न होना
18. **Vast** (adjective) – immense, enormous, extensive, huge, massive विशाल
19. **Veg out** (phrasal verb) – relax, laze, zone out, unwind, loaf आराम करना / निठल्ला बैठना
20. **Converse** (verb) – talk, chat, communicate, discuss, interact बातचीत करना

21. **Constructive** (adjective) – helpful, positive, productive, beneficial, meaningful
रचनात्मक
22. **Syncretic** (adjective) – unified, combined, amalgamated, blended, composite
समन्वयात्मक
23. **Radiate** (verb) – emit, shine, exude, spread, emanate फैलाना / प्रकट करना
24. **Propel** (verb) – drive, push, thrust, motivate, stimulate प्रेरित करना
25. **Narcissistic** (adjective) – self-obsessed, egotistic, vain, self-centered, conceited
आत्ममुग्ध
26. **Overcome** (verb) – conquer, defeat, surmount, prevail over, triumph काबू पाना
27. **Monotony** (noun) – dullness, boredom, repetitiveness, sameness, tedium एकरसता
28. **Starve** (verb) – go hungry, be deprived, famish, lack nourishment, underfeed भूखा रहना
29. **Rote** (noun) – memorization, repetition, routine, mechanical learning, drill रटने की प्रक्रिया
30. **Improvise** (verb) – adapt, invent, extemporize, devise, create सुधारना
31. **Reclaim** (verb) – recover, regain, retrieve, restore, take back पुनः प्राप्त करना
32. **Offshoot** (noun) – by-product, offshoot, branch, spin-off, outcome उप-प्रभाव / शाखा
33. **Exalt** (verb) – glorify, praise, elevate, celebrate, honour महिमा मंडित करना
34. **Turn one's sight on** (phrase) – focus on, aim at, target, direct attention to, concentrate on ध्यान केंद्रित करना
35. **Pursuit** (noun) – activity, quest, endeavor, hobby, chase गतिविधि / खोज
36. **Permeate** (verb) – spread, penetrate, infuse, saturate, infiltrate फैल जाना
37. **Toil** (noun) – hard work, labour, effort, struggle, exertion परिश्रम

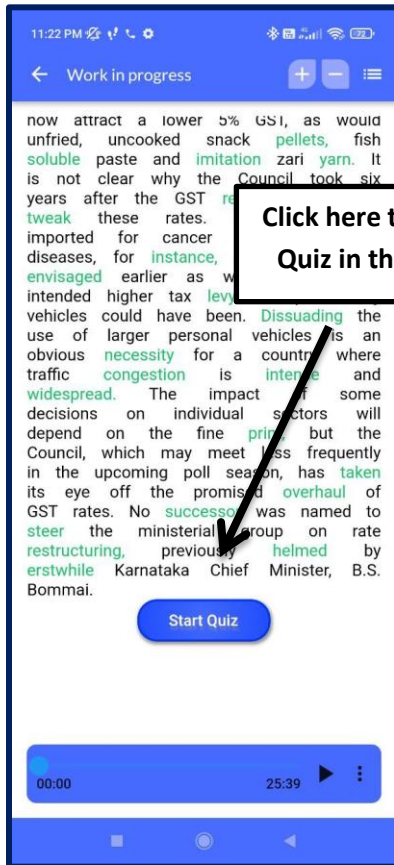
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. Most people work to earn a living and support their families.
2. Even those who are passionate about their jobs expect monetary compensation.
3. Many spend their entire working lives feeding only the body and mind, neglecting the soul.
4. Such neglect can have tragic consequences, including physical and emotional harm.
5. People often feel trapped in soul-crushing jobs with no alternatives.
6. However, it's possible to find joy by incorporating creative outlets into life.
7. Engaging in hobbies like music, gardening, painting, or handicrafts can nourish the soul.
8. These activities reduce stress, offer joy, and allow self-expression without pressure.
9. Creativity outside work improves performance and perspective at work.
10. It enhances efficiency, innovation, and interpersonal skills at the workplace.
11. Personal time becomes more meaningful, moving away from passive screen consumption.
12. You start noticing your surroundings more and engage meaningfully with others.
13. A sense of harmony between mind, body, and soul develops, boosting inner joy.
14. This transformation fosters compassion, positivity, and spiritual growth.
15. True fulfillment comes not just from what one earns, but from what one becomes through work.

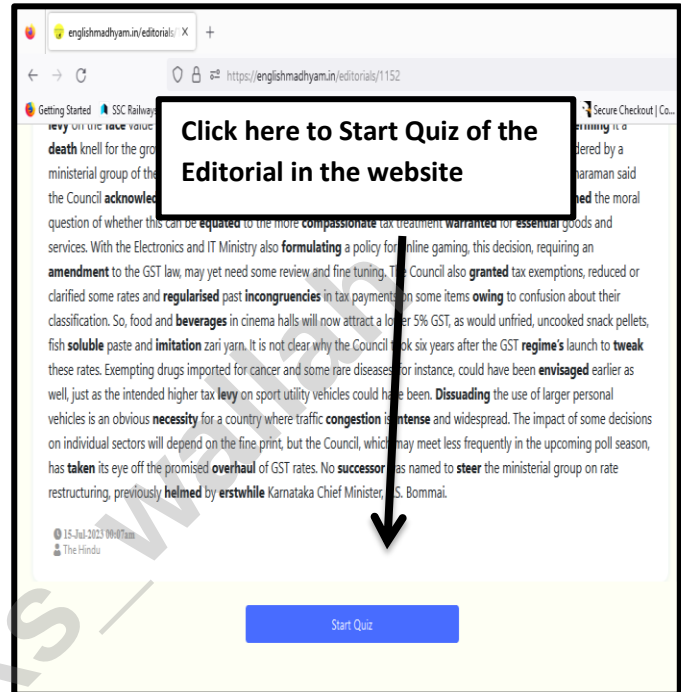
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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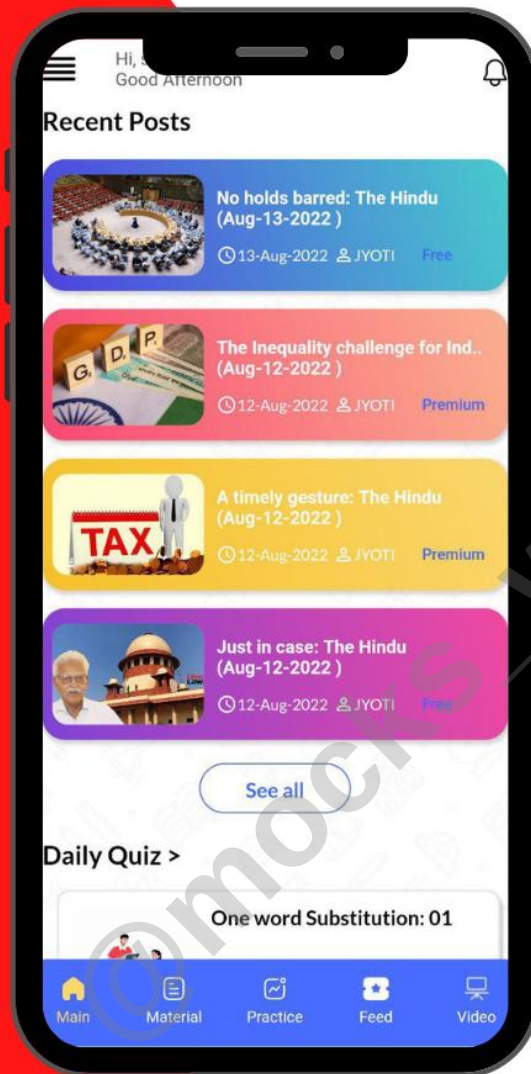
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